

Two Mile Borris TidyTowns

Project Tracker, 3 to 5 Year Plan



This document is a printable snapshot of the live Two Mile Borris TidyTowns project tracker at aburnsy.github.io/tidytowns/. The live site is the formal multi-year plan; this PDF is included as Attachment 2 of the 2026 submission so the adjudicator has a single static index of all projects, their status, benefit and cost. Each project title in the following pages links straight to its full page on the tracker, with supporting evidence and updates.

Snapshot generated 2026-05-09 · Live tracker: aburnsy.github.io/tidytowns/

Active Projects

Currently being delivered or scheduled within the current planning window.

010 Install water butts for watering planters and beds

Benefit: Medium

2026

sustainability

Status: Sensory Garden butt in active use; scouting additional sites

Cost: €100-150 per additional butt

Catching rainwater off village roofs and using it on the village's planters and in-ground beds rather than mains water. The village does not run hanging baskets, so the use case is the trough planters and the beds. Better water for the plants, lower running cost, and a visible sustainability story for the village.

013 Repaint bollards at monument area

Benefit: Low

2026

tidiness

Status: Planned 2026

Cost: €30-50

The bollards around the monument area have become worn and weathered, detracting from an otherwise well-maintained focal point. Repainting them is a straightforward, low-cost task that creates a noticeably tidier impression. This has been flagged in two consecutive adjudication reports.

016 Wildflower areas across the village estates

Benefit: Medium

2026

residential, nature-biodiversity

Status: Leighton Manor agreed, other estates and council still considering

Cost: €0-100 (signage only)

Rather than treat the wildflower idea as a single spot, we've gone out to every estate in the village and asked them to consider letting a section grow naturally. Some estates are managed by the residents themselves, others by Tipperary County Council, so it needs both conversations.

024 Sensory garden food bed, onions and garlic

Benefit: Medium

2026

sustainability, community, nature-biodiversity

Status: Planned autumn 2026 (Sept/Oct planting)

Cost: €30-80 (sets, seed garlic, compost)

A small food-growing bed in the sensory garden, planted out in September/October 2026 with onions and garlic. Both are deliberately chosen as low-maintenance autumn-planted crops that sit happily in the ground over winter, need almost no attention through the summer holidays when the children are out of school, and...

028 Bog Walk Phase 1: clearing and access works

Benefit: High

2026

nature-biodiversity, green-spaces, community

Status: Underway on the Ballyduff side, paid up front by Tidy Towns; LEADER grant secured to recoup

Cost: Around €10,000, paid up front by Tidy Towns. LEADER grant secured to cover the majority; once recouped, that money rolls into Phase 2.

The Bog Walk Loop is one of TMB's biggest amenity assets but was completely absent from the 2025 application. Phase 1 is about getting the loop back to a usable state, concentrated on the Ballyduff side. Phase 2 (surfacing for accessibility) and Phase 3 (biodiversity interpretation) sit as separate projects and follow...

045 Returning to Nature at St James parish

Benefit: High

2026

nature-biodiversity, community, sustainability

Status: Early conversations with the parish**Cost:** €0-100 (signage and survey materials)

In March 2023 the Irish Catholic Bishops' Conference asked parishes to manage 30% of church grounds for nature by 2030, in keeping with Laudato Si'. There's a Faith Community Pollinator Plan that sets out practical actions any parish can adopt, and a short repeatable insect survey (a Flower-Insect-Timed count) that...

019 Biodiversity-rich landscaping for graveyard extension

Benefit: High

2027

nature-biodiversity

Status: Planned 2027**Cost:** €500-1500

The cemetery has a recent extension, and that new ground is the obvious spot for a proper bit of biodiversity planting. The grave plots stay as they are, but the surrounding strips and corners can carry pollinator-friendly species without changing the feel of the place for visitors. We need Ann-Marie's read on what...

029 Bog Walk Phase 2: surface upgrade for accessibility

Benefit: High

2027

nature-biodiversity, green-spaces, community, accessibility

Status: Planned for 2027 once Phase 1 lands and recouped LEADER funds come back into the project**Cost:** TBC, scoped after Phase 1 completes. Intention is a second LEADER application.

Phase 1 (project 028) clears the route and lays a stone base course so the loop is usable again. Phase 2 takes the next step: a proper surface treatment so the loop is accessible to buggies, kids' bikes and walkers who aren't sure-footed enough for a rough track.

039 Add Slán Abhaile to back of village welcome signs

Benefit: Low

2027

approach-roads

Status: Planned 2027**Cost:** €300

Adding "Slán Abhaile" (Safe Home) to the reverse side of the village welcome signs is a small but characterful Irish-language touch that bids visitors farewell as they leave. Someone raised it at committee as a nice farewell for people leaving the village. Small, cheap, very us.

046 M8 motorway-exit roundabout, pollinator planting or unmown management

Benefit: Medium

2027

nature-biodiversity, approach-roads

Status: In design with Biodiversity Officer (multi-year)**Cost:** €0-500 (€0 unmown / €300-500 meadow planting)

The roundabout coming off the M8 Dublin-direction motorway exit is the first impression Two Mile Borris makes on visitors arriving from outside the county. Today it has no committee-led planting or management plan attached to it, and we have an opportunity to make it a recognisable gateway feature.

052 Settle the tracker site's home and wider village use

Benefit: Medium

2027

documentation, communications

Status: Committed for 2027, pick a host, agree any funding, and offer the format to other village groups**Cost:** €0-€20 (domain only, hosting stays free)

The public project tracker currently lives at <https://aburnsy.github.io/tidytowns/>, a personal GitHub Pages preview URL that was set up while the site was still a work in progress. The site has now grown into a real village asset (the formal multi-year plan, the village map, project pages, the heritage section), and...

053 Tiered seasonal display from rescued plastic pots

Benefit: Medium

2027

sustainability, streetscape

Status: Planned 2027

Cost: €200-500 (timber, paint, fixings) + €100-200/year planting

!Concept sketch of the tiered display: three stepped slatted timber tiers in village blue, with mixed-size plastic pots hidden inside each tier so only the seasonal planting shows above the top rail{ width="100%" }

036 Community EV charger at the (former) pump house

Benefit: High

2028

sustainability

Status: Concept, pending pump house decommissioning; informal SEAI contact made

Cost: TBC (capital + grant)

The village pump house is expected to be decommissioned in the near future. Crucially, the site already has three-phase power running to it, exactly the supply needed for a fast EV charger. We propose to apply, when the time is right, to convert the pump house site into a community EV charging point.

051 Village bat survey and habitat plan

Benefit: High

2028

nature-biodiversity

Status: Planned 2028, scoping an expert-led walk and a baseline survey before any boxes go up

Cost: €300-700 (detector, expert fees, signage)

A few people around the village have mentioned seeing bats flitting over the Old Road Triangle at dusk in the warmer months, and a couple more have spotted them along the Bog Walk where it runs by the drains. That is genuinely all we know. We don't know which species, we don't know how many, we don't know where...

030 Bog Walk Phase 3: biodiversity interpretation

Benefit: High

2029

nature-biodiversity, community, green-spaces

Status: Planned for 2029, follows Phases 1 and 2

Cost: €2000-5000 depending on panel count and design

Phase 1 (project 028) reopens the loop. Phase 2 (project 029) makes it accessible. Phase 3 turns it into an actual nature trail by adding biodiversity interpretation, so a walk on the loop teaches people what's growing and living around them.

040 Move away from chemical weed management by 2030

Benefit: Medium-High

2030

sustainability, nature-biodiversity

Status: Researching cost- and time-effective alternatives; multi-year transition through 2030

Cost: TBC, depends on the alternative we land on

Tipperary County Council does not directly maintain the village's hard surfaces and verges day to day. The Tidy Towns committee receives a council grant which we use to fund a local contractor for the village ground-maintenance round, and the contractor's standard practice includes chemical weed treatment on hard...

Future Projects

Multi-year ambitions on the public tracker, captured here as forward-look.

015 Garden competition across housing estates

Benefit: Medium

residential

Status: Future, when capacity allows

Cost: €100 (prizes)

A garden competition across the village housing estates encourages residents to take pride in their own front gardens and outdoor spaces. It is a proven way to engage newer residents, build community spirit, and improve the overall residential appearance of the village. Small prizes and public recognition can be...

020 Heritage interpretation panels at key village sites

Benefit: High

streetscape, community

Status: Future, when capacity or funding allows

Cost: €500-1000

Installing heritage interpretation panels at the Norman castle, the old forge, the church, and the bog walk entrance would transform these sites into an engaging open-air history trail. Good panels tell the story of a place, deepen community pride, and give visitors a reason to stop and read. Came up at committee as a...

022 Install replica window in the old forge

Benefit: Medium

streetscape

Status: Future, when capacity or funding allows

Cost: €500-2000

The old forge is a heritage building with significant character, but its empty window opening currently detracts from the streetscape. Installing a sympathetically designed replica window, guided by the County Heritage Officer, would restore the building's visual integrity and contribute to the overall quality of the...

025 Heritage trail linking castle, forge, church, and bog walk

Benefit: High

streetscape, community

Status: Future, when capacity or funding allows

Cost: €2500-4500

The village already has a Norman castle, an old forge, a working church and the bog walk entrance, but they sit as four separate stops a visitor has to know about already. A heritage trail is the connective layer: one orientation point in the centre of the village, low-profile wayfinding posts along the route, and a...

037 Conduct wildlife surveys (birds, pollinators, species)

Benefit: High

nature-biodiversity

Status: Future, FIT counts under project 045 cover the basics for now

Cost: €0-200

It came up at committee that we'd be a lot stronger with real survey numbers to point to year on year, a bird count, a pollinator count, maybe a wetland survey down by the bog walk. We can run them ourselves with the volunteer team, or rope in a local naturalist group for a hand. Beats vague claims that things are...

050 Seasonal photo coverage of village key spots

Benefit: Medium

documentation

Status: Future, when capacity allows

Cost: €0 (volunteer time only)

Set up a deliberate four-season photography sweep of the village's key spots so that the next application has spring, summer, autumn and winter coverage of the same locations side by side. The 2026 application leans heavily on the photos we already had on hand, which skews toward May 2026 and a handful of earlier...

Completed Projects

Projects delivered, captured for the application record.

047 Village-wide bulb planting, autumn 2025

Benefit: High

2025

green-spaces, community, approach-roads

Status: Completed autumn 2025

Cost: €1,143.51 (autumn 2025; shared with residential estates)

A big planting weekend in autumn 2025, TMB Tidy Towns volunteers joined by 15 volunteers from the residential estates. 11,100 bulbs went in across the village - the N75 approach road from Thurles, the extended seating area and several estate entrances. The alliums carry the show through May to July, well past the...

001 Litter pick 2026

Benefit: High

2026

sustainability, tidiness

Status: Completed April 2026

Cost: €0

Volunteers were out on four evenings in April and got through the bulk of the litter in the village and along the surrounding approach roads. The village itself was mostly the usual everyday bits and pieces. The approaches were a different story. Illegal dumping is a sad regular occurrence out there and this year was...

005 Mutt mitt dispenser kept stocked at monument

Benefit: Low

2026

tidiness

Status: Operational, kept stocked by the volunteer round

Cost: €20/yr

The adjudicator found the dispenser empty when they called in during 2025. It has since been restocked, however in no time it has been emptied again. Councillor Sean Ryan has kindly offered to get a large stockpile for us from Clonmel (Pending as of May 2026).

009 Unmown verge strips on approach roads

Benefit: Medium

2026

nature-biodiversity, approach-roads

Status: Delivered spring 2026

Cost: €0 (sign aside)

The adjudicator asked for unmown sections on the approach roads to support pollinators. We have significant strips at the seating area, the N75 approach roads and the approach from the Turnpike outside Leighton Manor. The native seed bank is doing the work, with our added allium bulbs coming up through it.

012 Cohesive village-wide pollinator planter scheme

Benefit: High

2026

green-spaces, nature-biodiversity, streetscape

Status: Completed May 2026; rolling top-up from split perennials as they mature

Cost: Significant Phase 1 spend on locally crafted blue trough planters; ~€100/yr ongoing as we propagate from splits rather than buying in annuals

A cohesive village-wide planter scheme, locally crafted blue wooden trough planters in a unified colour, filled with split perennials we propagate ourselves rather than annual bedding bought in every year. The planters tie the village together visually, dramatically improve the pollinator value of every container, and...

014 Derelict property improvements

Benefit: High

2026

streetscape

Status: Done for 2026

Cost: €0

The 2025 adjudicator asked us to do something about the look of derelict buildings around the village. The committee can't make property owners refurbish, and we don't want to claim credit for things that happen on private property independently of us. The honest position on this one is that a few good things have...

018 Sensory garden timber maintenance blitz

Benefit: Medium

2026

green-spaces

Status: Delivered spring 2026**Cost:** €250

The 2025 adjudicator flagged blocked paths and damaged timber. Spring 2026 we got stuck in: Michael Maher did an almighty job applying 2 coats of protective oil to all the wood. We repaired some damaged elements with locally sourced wood. Gravel paths were cleaned up. Reads as a proper sensory and learning space...

021 Our public project tracker and village map

Benefit: High

2026

community

Status: Live and growing**Cost:** €0 (built and hosted in-kind)

The site you're reading right now is the public tracker for everything TMB Tidy Towns is doing, and it's a properly cross-village piece of work. It is also our formal multi-year plan, in line with the adjudicator's repeated recommendation that committees publish a 3/5-year vision. The committee took the view that a...

043 Tidy Towns Instagram account

Benefit: Medium

2026

community

Status: Live and growing**Cost:** €0

Follow us at @twomileborristidytowns. The committee agreed we'd be daft not to have one, so we got it sorted. Builds public awareness, attracts volunteers, and is the kind of place you can drop a quick before-and-after of a planting day with no fuss.

048 Sensory garden willow weaving

Benefit: Medium

2026

green-spaces, community

Status: Delivered March 2026; next re-weave winter 2028 or 2029**Cost:** €0 (volunteer craft using existing willow)

Patrick Hayes reweave our living willow gateway for the sensory garden in March 2026. Volunteer craft, no cost. Living willow needs a light tidy each spring (tying in new growth, replacing the odd broken whip) and a full re-weave every two or three years to keep its shape. Next big re-weave pencilled in for late winter...